in 1966, four years before Fiji's independence, said it all. The British had engineered the implementation of the new 'London' constitution before decolonising Fiji and sponsored the Fijian-led Alliance Party to fight the predominantly 'Indian' Federation Party. The Alliance Party claimed to be 'promoting orderly progress towards internal self-government while maintaining and strengthening Fiji's link with the crown. The Alliance will work to preserve basic human rights and to safeguard the interests of all the Fijian community with special regard to minority groups.'

A report from the Indian embassy in Suva, dated 5 April 1967, said that the Alliance was an attempt to bring together representatives from all the communities of Fiji, including the Fijians, Indians, Europeans, Chinese and so on to show the world that they represented all of Fiji, in contrast to the Federation Party which was led by an ethnic Indian named A.D. Patel. The report said:

It was, in fact, a scheme obviously agreed upon by the Europeans and the Fijians to keep down the Federation which has been fighting for the cause of the people of Indian origin. The Alliance naturally sought for and took into their fold some Indians who joined them in the hope of getting rewards by way of appointment in the future government. As it proved later, when the election results came out, the Alliance was able to get their three Indians nominees elected in the cross voting constituencies and they accommodated two of them in the government which they formed: Vijay R. Singh as member for social services and K.S. Reddy as Parliamentary secretary in the same department. The net result is that the European and the Fijian group—the Fijians have implicit faith in the European leadership—have formed their own government with a couple